

SENATE BILL NO. 303

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A BILL FOR AN ACT ENTITLED: "AN ACT REQUIRING DESIGNATED STATE AGENCIES TO SUBMIT  
REPORTS TO THE OFFICE OF BUDGET AND PROGRAM PLANNING ON INFORMATION RELATED TO  
FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE PROVIDED TO TRIBAL ENTITIES; REQUIRING THE OFFICE OF BUDGET AND  
PROGRAM PLANNING TO COMPILE A REPORT ON FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE PROVIDED BY  
DESIGNATED STATE AGENCIES DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY TO TRIBAL ENTITIES AND SUBMIT THE  
REPORT IN AN ELECTRONIC FORMAT TO THE STATE-TRIBAL RELATIONS COMMITTEE, THE  
LEGISLATIVE FINANCE COMMITTEE, AND THE OFFICE OF STATE DIRECTOR OF INDIAN AFFAIRS;  
REQUIRING THE REPORT COMPILED BY THE OFFICE OF BUDGET AND PROGRAM PLANNING TO BE  
POSTED ON THE WEBSITE OF THE OFFICE OF STATE DIRECTOR OF INDIAN AFFAIRS; ESTABLISHING  
REPORTING REQUIREMENTS; PROVIDING DEFINITIONS; AND PROVIDING AN EFFECTIVE DATE."

BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

**NEW SECTION.** **Section 1. Definitions.** As used in [sections 1 and 2], unless the context clearly  
indicates otherwise, the following definitions apply:

- (1) (a) "Designated state agency" means:
  - (i) the department of administration;
  - (ii) the department of agriculture;
  - (iii) the Montana arts council;
  - (iv) the office of the state auditor;
  - (v) the board of regents;

- 1 (vi) the department of commerce;
- 2 (vii) the department of corrections;
- 3 (viii) the department of environmental quality;
- 4 (ix) the department of fish, wildlife, and parks;
- 5 (x) the governor's office;
- 6 (xi) the department of labor and industry;
- 7 (xii) the department of livestock;
- 8 (xiii) the department of military affairs;
- 9 (xiv) the Montana board of crime control;
- 10 (xv) the department of natural resources and conservation;
- 11 (xvi) the commissioner of political practices;
- 12 (xvii) the office of state public defender;
- 13 (xviii) the board of public education;
- 14 (xix) the department of public health and human services;
- 15 (xx) the office of public instruction;
- 16 (xxi) the public service commission;
- 17 (xxii) the department of revenue;
- 18 (xxiii) the school for the deaf and blind;
- 19 (xxiv) the office of the secretary of state;
- 20 (xxv) the state fund;
- 21 (xxvi) the state library;
- 22 (xxvii) the department of transportation;
- 23 (xxviii) the office of the commissioner of higher education; or
- 24 (xxix) the department of justice.
- 25 (b) The term does not include the judicial branch, the legislative branch, or an office or other entity
- 26 within the judicial branch or the legislative branch.
- 27 (2) (a) "Financial assistance" means assistance provided directly or indirectly to a tribal entity
- 28 either as state funds or as federal funds provided through a state agency to carry out a program. Financial

1 assistance may be in the form of grants, contracts, cooperative agreements, loans, loan guarantees, property,  
2 interest subsidies, insurance, AND direct appropriations, ~~or other noncash assistance~~, AND ELECTRONIC BENEFIT  
3 TRANSFER CARDS. The term includes awards received directly or indirectly by a tribal entity as state funds or as  
4 federal funds passed through a state agency directly or indirectly from a subrecipient. The granting agency is  
5 responsible for identifying the source of funds awarded to tribal entity recipients.

6 (b) The term does not include federal, state, or local government cash assistance provided directly  
7 to individuals.

8 (3) "Subrecipient" means a third party who receives state funds or federal funds through a state  
9 agency that the third party ultimately provides to a tribal entity in the form of financial assistance.

10 (4) "Tribal entity" means a tribal nation, tribal council, or tribal government located in the state.  
11

12 NEW SECTION. Section 2. Funding for tribal entities -- reporting. (1) Following the close of each  
13 fiscal year, a designated state agency that has distributed funds to a tribal entity or has received or retained  
14 funds related to a program that directly or indirectly provides financial assistance to a tribal entity shall prepare  
15 a report that identifies all financial assistance distributed by the designated state agency directly or indirectly to  
16 a tribal entity in the previous fiscal year.

17 (2) ~~The~~ UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFICALLY PROVIDED IN THE REPORT ISSUED BY THE DIRECTOR OF THE  
18 OFFICE OF INDIAN AFFAIRS, THE report UNDER THIS SECTION must provide the following information:

- 19 (a) the amount distributed directly to a tribal entity;  
20 (b) the amount distributed to a subrecipient that was ultimately distributed to a tribal entity;  
21 (c) the date the amount was distributed to a tribal entity or subrecipient;  
22 (d) the tribal entity receiving the financial assistance;  
23 (e) the federal assistance listings number, if applicable;  
24 (f) the purpose of the distribution;  
25 (g) the amount of ~~any management or administrative costs or fees assessed, charged, or retained~~  
26 ~~by the designated state agency for~~ ANY OVERHEAD RATE AND A GENERAL DESCRIPTION OF THE USES OF OVERHEAD  
27 FUNDING FOR distributing the financial assistance; AND

28 (h) for funds distributed pursuant to a program administered by a designated state agency, the

program through which the funds were distributed; ~~and; AND~~

(i) ~~for federal funds, any other amount retained by the state agency and for what purpose~~

(I) FOR FEDERAL FUNDS, ANY OTHER AMOUNT RETAINED BY THE STATE AGENCY AND FOR WHAT PURPOSE.

(3) A designated state agency that prepares a report in accordance with subsection (1) shall submit the report to the office of budget and program planning on or before ~~August 15~~ SEPTEMBER 8 NOVEMBER 1 of each year.

(4) The office of budget and program planning shall prepare an annual report that compiles and summarizes the reports that the office of budget and program planning receives in accordance with subsection (3).

(5) On or before ~~September 1~~ OCTOBER 1 DECEMBER 1 of each year, the office of budget and program planning shall submit the report required by subsection (4) to:

(a) the state-tribal relations committee, in accordance with 5-11-210;

(b) the office of state director of Indian affairs provided for in 2-15-217;

(c) each federally recognized tribal government in the state; and

(d) the legislative finance committee established in 5-12-201.

(6) The report required by subsection (4) must be posted on the website of the office of state director of Indian affairs.

**NEW SECTION. Section 3. Notification to tribal governments.** The secretary of state shall send a copy of [this act] to each federally recognized tribal government in Montana.

**NEW SECTION. Section 4. Codification instruction.** [Sections 1 and 2] are intended to be codified as a new part in Title 17, chapter 2, and the provisions of Title 17, chapter 2, apply to [sections 1 and 2].

**NEW SECTION. Section 5. Effective date.** [This act] is effective July 1, 2025.

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